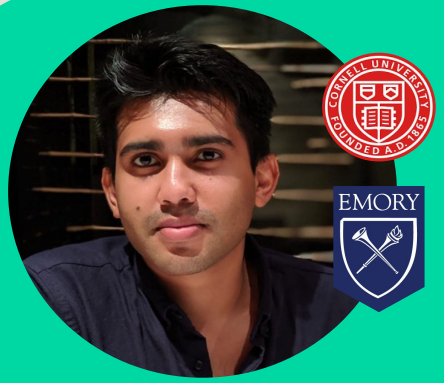
theApply.ai

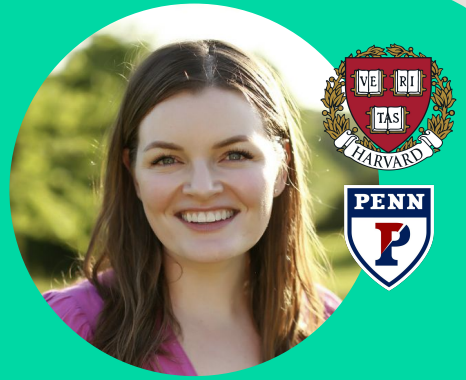
taking applicants from good to great

Who we are and why we're here



Vrijen Attawar
Co-founder & CEO

Cornell MBA
Ex-McKinsey
10+ years coaching



Logan Currie
Co-founder & COO

UPenn BA
Harvard Masters
15+ years coaching

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Our Game Plan Today

1. How to get an internship
2. How to make an impact during the internship
3. How to leverage that internship for future opportunities
4. Q&A

We can send you the deck!

Your 4 levers for job success

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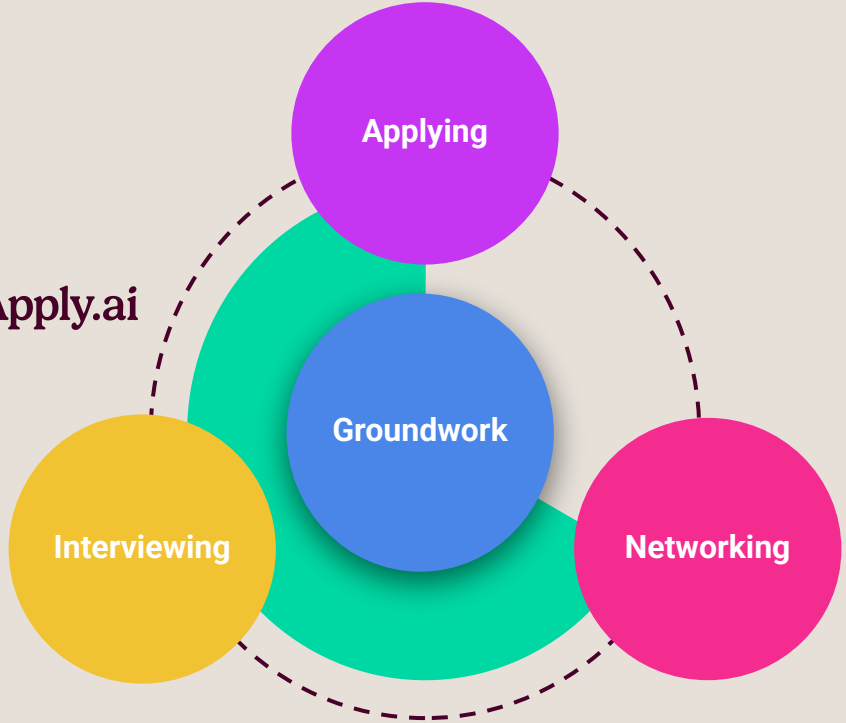

How to get an “institutional” internship

Company with an established process and desire for bringing in interns

Key features:

- Application “season” (large companies) or just-in-time recruiting
- Track record of recruiting interns over last 3-5 years
- Formal application process
- Joining as part of a cohort

Approach this like an applicant!

How NOT to approach things

1. **Jump straight into applying for internships** without doing enough groundwork
2. **Prioritize applying to "more" internships** over applying more effectively
3. **Spend time redesigning** materials that <u>don't need</u> to be designed (*don't submit* Canva resumes or PDF's to application systems)
4. **Submit the same or similar materials everywhere** - regardless of role or company
5. **Don't prepare for interviews** until he or she is invited
6. **Don't approach internship hunting systematically** and with attention to detail

How to approach this process

1. Apply to the **right internships** and **present yourselves in the right way**
2. Create **ATS and reader friendly materials tailored to the role** and company
3. Set yourself apart through their **knowledge of the company or the role**
4. **Prepare** for a **variety of interview questions and situations**
5. Put in **consistent and systematic effort**

Groundwork

The Checklist

What do I want? What do I have to offer?

- **Personal**
  - What am I looking for from my next job?
  - What are the ways in which I want to grow professionally?

Networking & Cover Letters

- **Work experiences**
  - What responsibilities have I fulfilled?
  - What impact have I had?
  - What skills and traits have I honed?

Resume, Cover letters, Networking

Pro tip: *Take detailed notes that you can use to prepare materials*

Bottom line

You are the world authority on yourself - act like it!

Applying

The Checklist: Resume

Targeted applying with tailored materials

- ❑ Does it prove I have experience with at least 70%+ of **the job responsibilities?**
- ❑ Do all of my bullets include an **"impact metric", "scale indicator"**, or **"skill reference"**?
- ❑ Does my skills section include 70%+ of the **hard and soft skills stated or implied by the JD**?
- ❑ Do I meet all the **required qualifications** and most of the **preferred qualifications**?

Pro tip: *Start with a master resume and "subtract" the irrelevant stuff. Color code if you're applying for multiple different roles*

Was this resume clearly prepared for this role?

Applying

The Checklist: Cover Letter

Targeted applying with tailored materials

- ❑ Does it include new information that doesn't repeat information on my resume?
- ❑ Does it clearly show why I want to take on this role at this particular company?
- ❑ Is it under ½ a page?
- ❑ Is it addressed to the hiring manager?

Pro tip: *Cover the company name. If the cover letter reads like it could apply to any company, then it's not good enough*

Super pro tip: *Look at Glassdoor to get the inside scoop on a company*

Was this cover letter clearly written for this role and company?

Bottom line

Companies have more options than you

You won’t be taken seriously unless you show you’re serious about the role

How to create your own internship

Company (usually a small one) that does not run regular internship programs

- No set timings or duration
- No specific application cycle
- No established processes for vetting interns
- Not factoring interns into their hiring decision-making
- You will likely be the only intern

Approach this like an entrepreneur!

How to create your own internship

1. Pick an industry or role in which you would like more experience
   If optimizing for industry
   - ❑ Research the problem spaces and solutions
   - ❑ Understand the players and their role in the ecosystem

   If optimizing for role
   - ❑ Analyze entry level roles in that position
   - ❑ Compare your skills to the responsibilities - which ones can you do?
2. Find companies in the “goldilocks” zone (5-50 employees)
3. Hustle!
   - ❑ Check out their socials (don’t forget Glassdoor!)
   - ❑ Look at their job board - what roles are they hiring for?
   - ❑ Find founders/team members who post frequently on LinkedIn - engage with their content
   - ❑ Put forward a “case for myself” - email, LI messages, “cold” applying, etc.

Pro tips for creating your own internships

1. Don’t be shy! The only way this works is if you put yourself out there. If you do it right, people will respect it!
2. Be thoughtful - no one wants to receive a cookie-cutter message
3. Be open-minded - there are a lot of great companies out there. Look broadly!
4. Be *specific* about the value you can give to them
5. Learn from your mistakes and iterate on your approach
6. Don’t lose hope - it’s all a number’s game!

Networking

What it takes: The cold outreach

A little research goes a long way

- ❏ Does it show that I've taken the time to research the person and their company?
- ❏ Is it written in a friendly but professional manner?
- ❏ Is there are clear ask at the end? (we recommend a 10-minute conversation to discuss the role and company)
- ❏ Am I showing off my best self? (this includes LinkedIn)

Pro tip: *Don't jump right into asking for a referral; have at least one conversation before asking them to put in a word*

Super pro tip: *ALWAYS ALWAYS ALWAYS send a "thank you" message the next day*

Was this message clearly written for this role and company?

Bottom line

No one wants to waste their time

Most people want to help someone who comes off as professional, reliable, and enthusiastic

Interviewing

What it takes

Prepare flexibly and in advance

Preparing

- ❑ Do I have a polished 1-2 minute answer for “tell me about yourself?”
- ❑ Have I thought through the anecdote for my key achievements?
- ❑ Do I have answers about my strengths and my weaknesses?

Content

Practicing

- ❑ Can I deliver answers without looking at a script?
- ❑ Can I deliver answers while staring at myself on camera?

Delivery

Pro tip: *Write out each anecdote in the START (Situation, Task, Action, Result, Takeaway) format*

Bottom line

The best interview prep is knowing yourself inside and out

What it takes: At the internship

The internship

Impress through your actions and attitude

As an individual

- ❑ Am I completing everything asked of me to the required standard?
- ❑ Am I conveying a genuine desire to learn and improve?
- ❑ Am I showing “marked improvement” over time?
- ❑ Am I coming off as an independent worker?
- ❑ Am I recording my contributions, impact, and growth?

As a teammate

- ❑ Am I reliable?
- ❑ Am I making others’ lives easier or harder?

Pro tip *if you’re doing a good job, you’ll be trusted to do more complex and important tasks*

Would I want to hire me back?

What it takes: After the internship

The internship

Where can I go from here?

Maximize the value of your experience

Short run

- ❑ Have I reflected on my takeaways and adjusted my goals accordingly?
- ❑ Have I updated my master resume?
- ❑ Have I added key relationships on LinkedIn?
- ❑ Have I sent everyone that helped me succeed a personalized “thank you”?

Long run

- ❑ Have I stayed in touch with my former managers?

Pro tip *it’s easiest to handle takeaways and “thank yous” if you keep a running list*

Q&A

This is your time!
What can we help with?

Thank you for joining us!

the Apply Ai | Beta V.1.2

A

Interview summary

You can modify and save the interview summary form, then save it as a PDF file.

Open the conversation

Download PDF file

Content Table

- About me
- Elevator pitch
- LinkedIn About Me Page
- Summary
- Responsibilities
- Resume Bullet Points
- Metrics

Helper tool

How we got it

How is work

LinkedIn About Me Page

Edit

Copy

Fueled by a passion for crafting immersive digital experiences, with a knack for identifying user requirements and implementing a comprehensive UI/UX design strategy. Think: high-impact visual designs, intricate flow diagrams, wireframes, and prototypes 🎯. Successful track record in interfacing with marketing teams, internal/external designers, delivering custom-tailored experiences 👥. Fluent in UX research methodologies and testing activities, always seeking to get under the skin of user behavior 📊. A stickler for style standards around typography and graphic design, ensuring each pixel is where it should be 🎨. Transformed digital real estates with intuitive UI elements and rigorous testing, resulting in high-performing CTAs, engaging page layouts, and smooth user flows for landing pages. Aim? Deliver consistently ahead-of-the-curve designs for tomorrow. 💡

Feedback

If you want to try our tool

SCAN ME

www.retro.theapply.ai

If you want a copy of the slides

Email vrijen@theapply.ai

Average # of applicants for a corporate role: **250**

Avg # of candidates interviewed: **5**

There has been a **40%** increase in avg applications per candidate - **just in 2023**

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